

THE EXAMINATION SYSTEM, AUDITED

India's Exam-Integrity Crisis

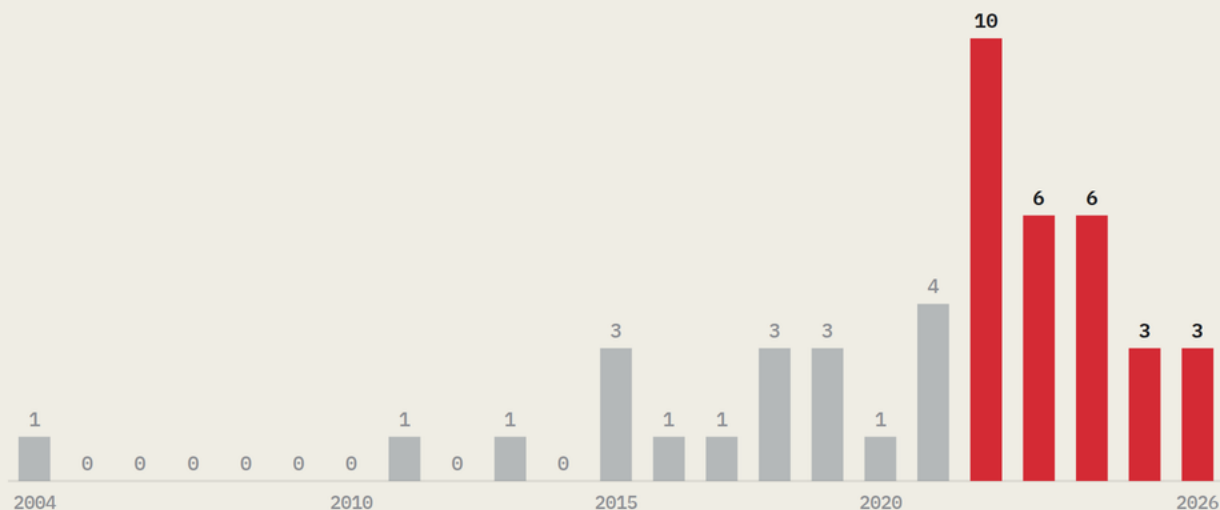
47 cancelled exams. **3.15 crore** aspirants. One broken promise —
repeated for 22 years.

CANCELLED
x 4 7 x

6 in 10

cancellations have struck in just the last five years.

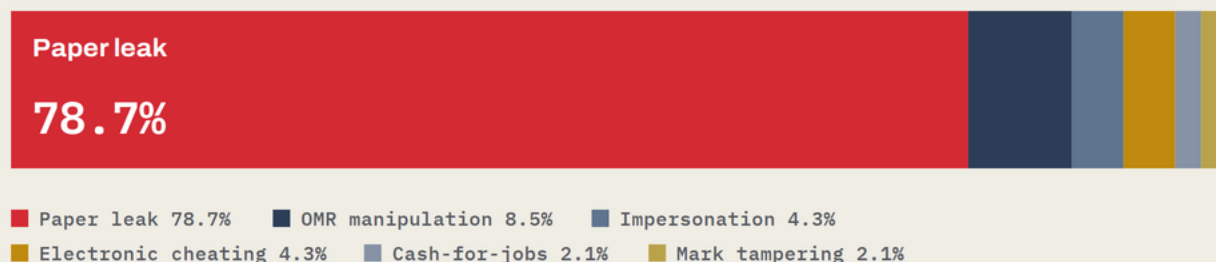
A problem two decades in the making has detonated since 2021. **2022 alone** saw ten exams scrapped — more than the first sixteen years combined.



78.7%

of cancellations weren't accidents. The paper had already leaked.

Nearly eight in ten exams were scrapped because questions escaped before the bell. The remainder: OMR manipulation, impersonation, electronic cheating and cash-for-jobs.



60%

chasing a government job — plus 21%
sitting for a college seat.

The people who pay aren't statistics.

Of the **3.15 crore** aspirants caught in these cancellations, six in ten had sat a recruitment exam — the test standing between them and a stable public-sector livelihood.

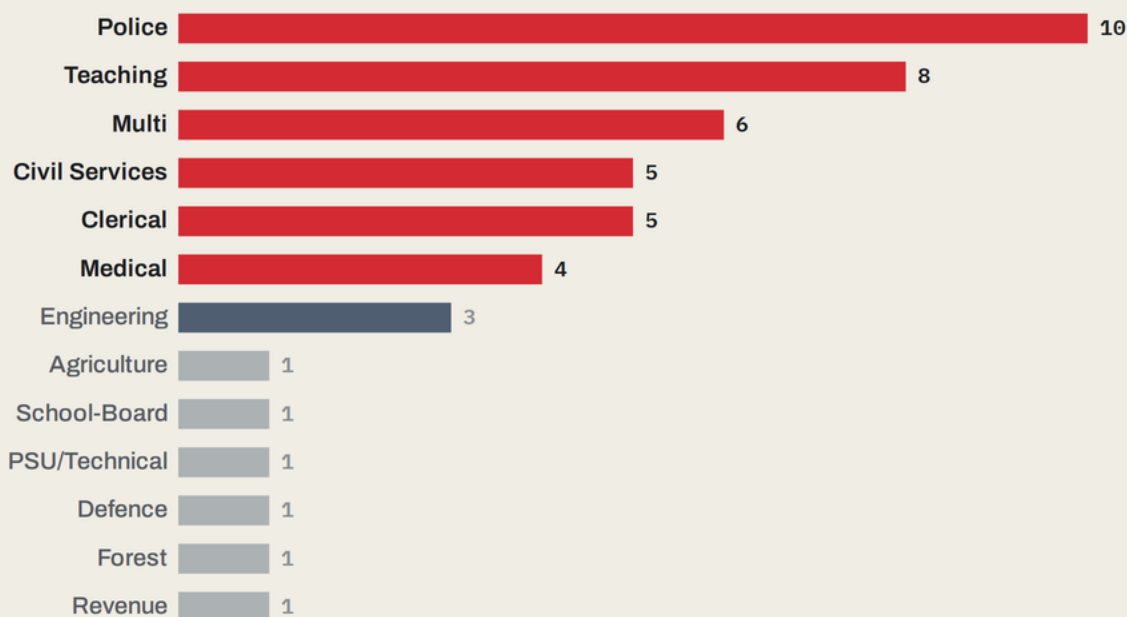


■ Recruitment 60.4% ■ Admission 21.4% ■ Eligibility 16.3% ■ Board 1.9%

80%

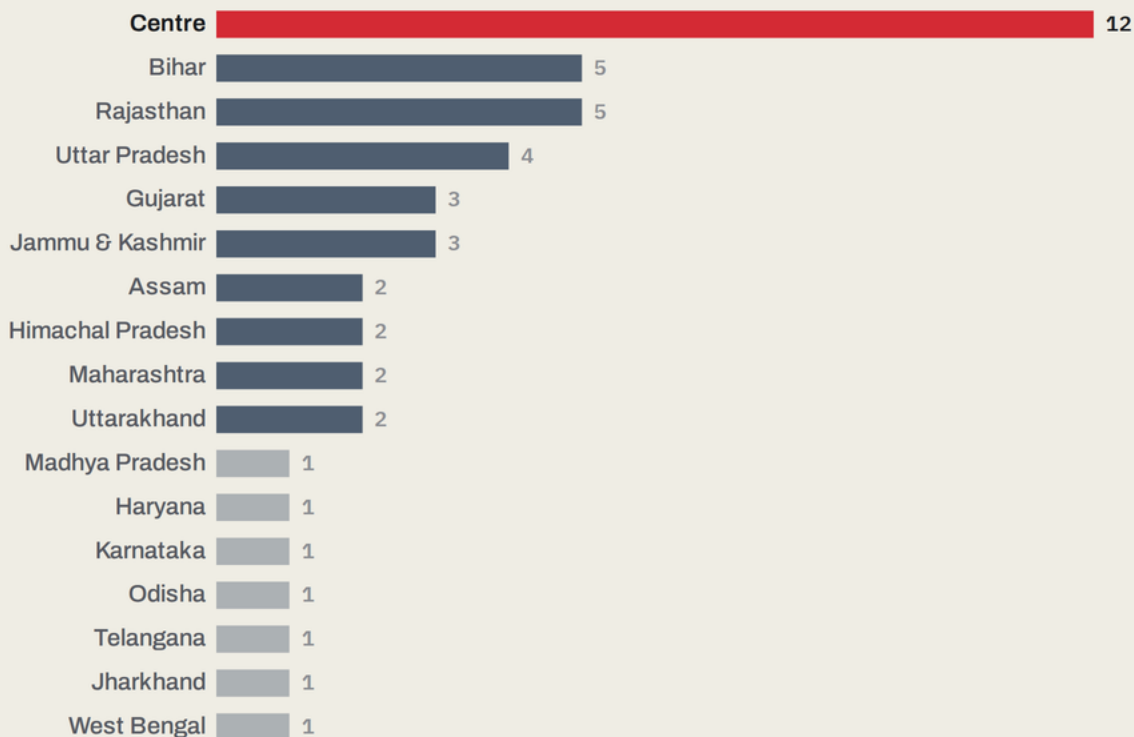
of cancellations hit just six sectors.

Led by **policing, teaching and the civil services** — the exams that decide who gets a secure public job. The damage clusters exactly where opportunity is scarcest.



A nationwide failure — but the **Centre** owns the single biggest share.

Cancellations reached 16 states and union territories. Yet central bodies — NEET, SSC, UGC-NET, CBSE — account for **12 on their own**, more than any single state.



66%

happened while the NDA held power.

Two-thirds of all cancellations fall under NDA-led governments, a quarter under UPA/INDIA. The alliance in office also governed for more of this 22-year window — the timeline, not just the tally, tells the story.



■ NDA 66.0% ■ UPA / INDIA 25.5% ■ Regional 6.4% ■ INDIA (2024-) 2.1%